4 Controller

Controllers in Laravel are essential for handling application logic. They receive requests from routes, process the input, and return responses. This chapter introduces the different types of controllers, how to create them, and best practices for organizing your controller logic in Laravel 12.

4.1 What is a Controller?

In the MVC (Model-View-Controller) pattern, a **controller** acts as the bridge between the **model** and the **view**. It handles user input, interacts with models for data, and returns the correct response—often rendering a view.

4.2 Creating a Controller

To generate a controller, use the Artisan command:

```
php artisan make:controller PageController
```

This creates a controller at:

```
app/Http/Controllers/PageController.php
```

Here’s a simple controller that returns a view:

```
namespace App\Http\Controllers;

use Illuminate\Http\Request;

class PageController extends Controller
{
    public function home()
    {
        return view('home');
    }
}
```

Register it in the route file:

```
use App\Http\Controllers\PageController;

Route::get('/home', [PageController::class, 'home']);
```